



CONFLICT WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 8 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 14 SEPTEMBER 2026

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 8 Sep - 14 Sep 2026	DISTINCT INCIDENTS 55 Conflict incidents this period	HIGHEST SEVERITY Extreme Highest rating this period
TOP EVENT TYPE Armed Clashes 24 records	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY Myanmar 13 records	LATEST INCIDENT 14 Sep 2026

BLUF

The current picture is one of active conflict zones producing direct effects on transport links, civilian locations and essential services rather than isolated violence. The clearest concentration is in Myanmar, where reported incidents span air attack, ground fighting, landmine harm, school closures and transport disruption.

Elsewhere, the reporting window shows sustained armed pressure in western Pakistan, renewed insurgent contact in the Philippines, and continuing lethal violence in India's Manipur and in Papua. These are separate theatres, but they point to the same operational issue: security conditions can tighten quickly around roads, airports, public-sector movements and exposed fixed sites.

TOP ACTIVITY AREAS

MYANMAR

Myanmar's sharpest activity this period centres on Rakhine State and Sagaing Region, where bombings, airstrikes and insurgent attacks are threatening roads, checkpoints, convoy movement and nearby worksites. The rest of Myanmar has stayed largely clear. Recent cases involved a bombing or airstrike near Sagaing Region with casualties reported on 9 Sep and a bombing or airstrike in Myanmar with casualties reported on 13 Sep. Several of these attacks killed people.

INDIA

India saw heavier activity around Manipur and the Maoist (Naxal) belt, where armed clashes and insurgent attacks can reach government and security sites and nearby worksites. These included an insurgency attack in India with casualties reported on 9 Sep and an insurgency attack near Manipur with casualties reported on 14 Sep. Some proved lethal.

PAKISTAN

Pakistan also registered activity around Balochistan, where insurgent attacks and armed clashes have struck government and security sites and nearby worksites. Notable cases involved an insurgency attack near Balochistan with casualties reported on 10 Sep and an insurgency attack in Pakistan with casualties reported on 8 Sep. There were fatalities.

OTHER WATCHED THEATRES

Lower-level activity also showed in Sri Lanka, Philippines, Indonesia, Malaysia and West Papua. The most notable case involved an armed clash in Sri Lanka with casualties reported on 14 Sep in Sri Lanka. It was quieter there this period, but any of these could worsen quickly on a single clash or attack, so they stay on watch.

WHAT MATTERS FOR BUSINESS

The Myanmar incidents matter because they affected both people and the networks that keep movement possible. The Mandalay airport shutdown is the clearest immediate disruption point in this window, while bridge damage near Bhamo and school closures in Karenni show conflict reaching transport routes and community infrastructure.

Pakistan's incidents point to continued pressure around Balochistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, where security operations and attempted attacks can trigger sudden checkpoints, route restrictions and delayed overland movement. In Manipur and Papua, the pattern is more localised but still material: armed attacks on civilians and civil servants raise the risk around district travel, government-linked movements and access to remote areas.

The fighting in the Philippines is more contained geographically, but the reports from Caraga, Agusan del Sur and Leyte show that insurgent-linked security activity remains active in parts of the south and east. That can affect travel timing and access even without broader nationwide disruption.

WATCH NEXT

- Further drone activity around Mandalay could trigger another airport shutdown or wider airside restrictions.
- Additional junta airstrikes in Sagaing, Rakhine, Magway or Karenni could cause more civilian harm and fresh closures of schools or local routes.
- If fighting continues near Bhamo or along the Sittwe-Ponnagyun axis, transport disruption may spread through damaged infrastructure and contested roads.

- Further security operations in Balochistan could bring short-notice movement controls, especially if militant attacks continue to expand into the Pashtun belt.
- Renewed militant violence in Manipur remains possible if armed actors continue attacks around sensitive local anniversaries or in districts such as Tamenglong.
- More clashes with the NPA in Caraga or nearby areas could lead to added checkpoints and disrupted road movement in eastern Philippines.

POLESTAR VIEW

Risk level: High. The main disruption risk sits in Myanmar, where conflict is already affecting aviation, roads and community infrastructure, with a secondary focus on Balochistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa in Pakistan. Keep movement plans flexible, verify routes immediately before travel, and push rapid updates where airport access, bridge status or local security operations change.

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